World War I

There are various reasons including political and military tensions that led to World War I. The main reason that is often cited involves the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand from Austria-Hungary. When the Archduke visited Sarajevo in Bosnia on June 28, 1914, he was assassinated by a man named Princip. Princip was a member of a terrorist group called the Black Hand and had his own political motives for the assassination. Princip and his gang members were frustrated at the fact that Serbs in Bosnia did not have their own government and blamed the Austrian-Hungarian government.

After the assassination, a period of time known as the July Crisis occurred. During this time, Germany, Britain, Austria-Hungary, France and Russia all went through sensitive political movements. Austria-Hungary issued a series of demands known as the July Ultimatum to Serbia on July 23rd. The ultimatum suggested that Austria-Hungary would enter Serbia with its military to investigate the death of the Archduke. The Serbian government read all of the terms of the ultimatum and refused the military intervention Austria-Hungary had suggested. This triggered the first country to declare war; a war that eventually impacted the entire world.

Officially, World War I began on July 28, 1914 when Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia. Although it originated between two small countries, it soon spread throughout the rest of Europe to France, Great Britain, Russia, and Germany. It spread quickly to all of these nations because they had formed various treaties with one another that forced them to aid their allied nations. Frontlines were quickly established across the Austrian-Hungarian and German borders.